

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical law-firm experience at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, alongside current legal advisory roles at Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Q-Legal. Experienced in matter management, document control, deadline tracking, cost comparisons and maintaining accurate, confidential records using iManage and case management systems. Familiar with law-firm processes including matter opening and closure, electronic filing and structured file organisation. Detail-focused, reliable and accustomed to working within firm procedures and financial timelines.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize — top 20 of a 200-student cohort; carried partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Assisted with matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons across several concurrent matters
- Maintained matter records and organised large volumes of confidential documents via iManage
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with court filings and managed hearing arrangements
- Conducted legal and factual research; prepared client notes and court materials to tight timelines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the sole junior on the team ahead of a significant submission deadline
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated with an external translator on Romanian materials
- Received partner and associate feedback that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters end-to-end: prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets submission deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points

- Drafts correspondence and applications; maintains organised, accurate case files across welfare, employment, housing and debt matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under qualified solicitor supervision
- Produced clearly structured written output to a set deadline; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor throughout
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and flagged provisions requiring legal input
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; case management and time-recording systems; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling and document review; legal and commercial research databases; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; qualitative interviewing; concise report writing

Case and evidence management: Matter opening and closure; deadline and cost tracking; confidential document control; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; structured electronic file organisation